Teacher answer key

Expected answers for the ALEF printable sets: First 10 minutes, the cursive words workbook, the vowel signs (niqqud) workbook and the read-aloud sheets. The vocabulary flashcards carry their own answers on the card.

TEACHER COPY, DRAFT: answers derived from course data, not reviewed by a Hebrew teacher; transliteration machine-made; not tested with learners. Pronunciation shown is Modern Israeli unless a column says otherwise. Where a learner reads a word differently, check the community's custom before marking it wrong.

First 10 minutes: the three words

Word	Unpointed	Sound	Meaning
שָׁלוֹם	שלום	shah-LOHM	peace
שָׁם	שם	shahm	there
מָה	מה	mah	what

Check question “Which one says shalom?”: שָׁלוֹם (shah-LOHM). The other two are שָׁם there and מָה what.

The ladder pass rule is a target, not a measured result. A word read after the hint is not counted as read unpointed.

The 20-step ladder

#	Stage	Shown	With points	Sounds like	Meaning
1	Fully pointed	שָׁלוֹם	שָׁלוֹם	shalom	peace
2	Fully pointed	שָׁם	שָׁם	sham	there
3	Fully pointed	מָה	מָה	mah	what
4	Fully pointed	לֹא	לֹא	lo	no, not
5	Fully pointed	טוֹב	טוֹב	tov	good
6	Fully pointed	יוֹם	יוֹם	yom	day
7	First letter pointed	אָב	אָב	av	father
8	First letter pointed	כֹּל	כֹּל	kol	all
9	First letter pointed	גַּם	גַּם	gam	also
10	First letter pointed	כֵּן	כֵּן	ken	yes
11	First letter pointed	אֵין	אֵין	ein	there is not
12	First letter pointed	יֵשׁ	יֵשׁ	yesh	there is
13	Unpointed, with a hint	מים	מַיִם	mayim	water
14	Unpointed, with a hint	בית	בַּיִת	bayit	house
15	Unpointed, with a hint	ספר	סֵפֶר	sefer	book
16	Unpointed, with a hint	תודה	תּוֹדָה	todah	thanks
17	Unpointed, with a hint	שנה	שָׁנָה	shanah	year
18	Unpointed, with a hint	עוד	עוֹד	od	more, still
19	Unpointed, no hint	אבל	אֲבָל	aval	but
20	Unpointed, no hint	אמא	אִמָּא	ima	mom

The 27 letter forms

#	Letter	Name	Sound	IPA	Gematria
1	א	Alef	silent / a tiny glottal stop, like the pause in 'uh-oh'	/ʔ/	1
2	ב	Bet	b with a dot (bet), v without (vet)	/b ~ v/	2
3	ג	Gimel	g as in go	/g/	3
4	ד	Dalet	d as in door	/d/	4
5	ה	He	h as in hat	/h/	5
6	ו	Vav	v as in van	/v/	6
7	ז	Zayin	z as in zoo	/z/	7
8	ח	Chet	throaty ch, like Bach	/χ/	8
9	ט	Tet	t as in top	/t/	9
10	י	Yod	y as in yes	/j/	10
11	כ	Kaf	k with a dot (kaf), throaty ch without (khaf)	/k ~ χ/	20
12	ל	Lamed	l as in lamp	/l/	30
13	מ	Mem	m as in map	/m/	40
14	נ	Nun	n as in net	/n/	50
15	ס	Samekh	s as in sun	/s/	60
16	ע	Ayin	silent in modern Israeli Hebrew (like alef)	/ʔ/	70
17	פ	Pe	p with a dot (pe), f without (fe)	/p ~ f/	80
18	צ	Tsadi	ts as in cats	/ts/	90
19	ק	Qof	k as in kite	/k/	100
20	ר	Resh	back-of-throat r, like French r	/ʁ/	200
21	ש	Shin	sh as in ship (sin, dot on the left, is s)	/ʃ/	300
22	ת	Tav	t as in top	/t/	400
23	ך	Kaf sofit	same as kaf, only at the end of a word	/k ~ χ/	500*
24	ם	Mem sofit	same as mem, only at the end of a word	/m/	600*
25	ן	Nun sofit	same as nun, only at the end of a word	/n/	700*
26	ף	Pe sofit	same as pe, only at the end of a word	/p ~ f/	800*
27	ץ	Tsadi sofit	same as tsadi, only at the end of a word	/ts/	900*

* 500-900 for the five final forms is a widely used convention.

Cursive words workbook: the words, pointed and unpointed

1. Alef א

אַבָּא		aba	dad
אִמָּא		ima	mom
אָז		az	so

2. Bet ב

בֵּית		beit	house of
בַּבַּיִת		babayit	in the house
בֶּאֱמֶת		be'emet?	really?

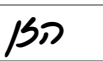
3. Gimel ג

גַּן		gan	garden
גֶּשֶׁם		geshem	rain
גָּדוֹל		gadol	big

4. Dalet ד

דַּי		dai	enough / stop it
דֶּרֶךְ		derekh	way

5. He ה

הַיּוֹם		hayom	today
הֵי		hey	hi
הַזָּן		hazan	who feeds

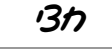
6. Vav ו

וָואלָה		wallah	really? / wow / honestly
וָעֶד		va'ed	and ever
וְאָנִי		ve'ani	and I

7. Zayin ז

זָהָב		zahav	gold
זֶה		zeh	this
זוֹל		zol	cheap

8. Chet ח

חֲצִי		chetsi	half
חָבֵר		chaver	friend
חוּמוּס		humus	hummus

9. Tet ט

טוֹב		tov	OK / well / good
טֹבוּ		tovu	good are
טַל		tal	dew

Cursive words workbook: the words, pointed and unpointed

10. Yod י

יָמִינָה	*ימינה*	yamina	right
יֶלֶד	*ילד*	yeled	boy; child
יַיִן	*יין*	yayin	wine

11. Kaf כ

כֵּן	*כן*	ken	yes
כְּלוֹמַר	*כלומר*	klomar	that is / I mean
כִּי	*כי*	ki	because

12. Lamed ל

לֶחֶם	*לחם*	lechem	bread
לַיְלָה	*לילה*	laylah	night
לֹא	*לא*	lo	no

13. Mem מ

מַיִם	*מים*	mayim	water
מֶלֶךְ	*מלך*	melekh	king
מִשְׁפָּחָה	*משפחה*	mishpachah	family

14. Nun נ

נְסִיעָה	*נסיעה*	nesi'ah	ride; trip
נוּ	*נו*	nu	well? / come on
נָכוֹן	*נכון*	nachon	right / correct

15. Samekh ס

סָלָט	*סלט*	salat	salad
סֵפֶר	*ספר*	sefer	book
סִדּוּר	*סדור*	sidur	prayer book

16. Ayin ע

עֶזְרָה	*עזרה*	ezra!	help!
עֲשָׂרָה	*עשרה*	asara	ten (10)
עֶשְׂרִים	*עשרים*	esrim	twenty (20)

17. Pe פ

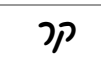
פִּיתָה	*פיתה*	pita	pita bread
פָּתוּחַ	*פתוח*	patuach	open
פָּלָאפֶל	*פלאפל*	falafel	falafel

18. Tsadi צ

צֶדֶק	*צדק*	tzedek	justice
צְדָקָה	*צדקה*	tzedakah	charity; justice

Cursive words workbook: the words, pointed and unpointed

19. Qof ק

קוֹל		kol	voice
קָפֶה		kafeh	coffee
קַר		kar	cold

20. Resh ר

רֹאשׁ		rosh	head
רַכֶּבֶת		rakevet	train
רֶגַע		rega	one moment

21. Shin ש

שָׁלוֹם		shalom	hello / goodbye / peace
שֶׁמֶשׁ		shemesh	sun
שְׂמֹאלָה		smola	left

22. Tav ת

תּוֹדָה		toda	thank you
תּוֹרָה		torah	Torah
תִּשְׁעָה		tish'a	nine (9)

23. Kaf sofit ך

מֶלֶךְ		melekh	king
דֶּרֶךְ		derekh	way
לַמֶּלֶךְ		lamelekh	to the king

24. Mem sofit ם

מַיִם		mayim	water
שָׁלוֹם		shalom	hello / goodbye / peace
הַיּוֹם		hayom	today

25. Nun sofit ן

יַיִן		yayin	wine
בֵּן		ben	son
גַּן		gan	garden

26. Pe sofit ף

אֶלֶף		elef	one thousand (1000)
עוֹדֵף		odef	change
אַף		af	also; nose

27. Tsadi sofit ץ

אֶרֶץ		eretz	land

Vowel signs workbook: example words

Kamatz (kamatz gadol) ָ · a as in father (short, no glide)

1	אֲבָל	aval	but
2	סָלָט	salat	salad
3	לְאָן	le'an?	where to?
4	יָשָׁר	yashar	straight ahead
5	אֶחָד	echad	one (1)
6	שִׁשָּׁה	shisha	six (6)

Patach בַ · a as in father

1	אַחִי	achi	my brother (bro)
2	רֶגַע	rega	one moment
3	מַיִם	mayim	water
4	יַיִן	yayin	wine
5	רֶבַע	reva	quarter
6	שַׁבָּת	shabat	Sabbath

Tzere בֵ · e as in bed (a few words and speakers say ei as in they)

1	מֵאָה	me'a	one hundred (100)
2	חָבֵר	chaver	friend
3	בֵּית	beit	house of
4	אָמֵן	amen	amen
5	סֵפֶר	sefer	book
6	יָאֵר	ya'er	may He shine

Segol בֶ · e as in bed

1	אֶלֶף	elef	one thousand (1000)
2	מֶלֶךְ	melekh	king
3	דֶּרֶךְ	derekh	way
4	אֱמֶת	emet	truth
5	צֶדֶק	tzedek	justice
6	אֶרֶץ	eretz	land

Vowel signs workbook: example words

Chirik בִ · i as in machine (short)

1	חֲצִי	chetsi	half
2	שִׁיר	shir	song
3	אִמָּא	ima	mom
4	אֲנִי	ani	I
5	יִשָּׂא	yisa	may He lift
6	פְּרִי	peri	fruit of

Cholam בֹ · o as in for (no glide)

1	רֹאשׁ	rosh	head
2	קוֹל	kol	voice
3	כֻּלּוֹ	kulo	all of it
4	טֹבוּ	tovu	good are
5	הַכֹּל	hakol	the all
6	אֹכֶל	okhel	food

Kubutz בֻ · oo as in boot (short)

1	כֻּלָּם	kulam	all of them
2	מְצֻיָּן	metsuyan	excellent
3	מְזֻמָּן	mezuman	cash
4	וִיחֻנֶּךָּ	vichuneka	and be gracious to you
5	חֻשַּׁב	chushav	to be calculated
6	יֻדַּע	yuda	to be informed

Shuruk בּוּ · oo as in boot

1	מוּל	mul	opposite
2	הוּא	hu	he
3	שׁוּב	shuv	again; return!
4	רוּחַ	rucha	spirit; wind
5	אוּלַי	ulai	maybe
6	פָּתוּחַ	patuach	open

Vowel signs workbook: example words

Shva ְ · e as in begin, or silent

1	שְׁמַע	shema	hear!
2	שְׁמֵהּ	shemeh	His name (Aramaic)
3	מָלַךְ	malakh	He reigned
4	שְׁמִי	shemi	my name is
5	בְּטַח	betach	sure / of course
6	שְׁנַיִם	shnayim	two (2)

Chataf patach ֲ · very short a as in father

1	אֲנִי	ani	I
2	חֲמִשָּׁה	chamisha	five (5)
3	עֲשָׂרָה	asara	ten (10)
4	יַעֲקֹב	ya'akov	Jacob
5	אֲדוֹן	adon	lord of
6	תַּחֲנָה	tachanah	station; stop

Chataf segol ֱ · very short e as in bed

1	בֶּאֱמֶת	be'emet?	really?
2	אֱלֹהֵי	elohei	God of
3	אֱלֹהִים	elohim	God
4	אֱלֹהֵינוּ	eloheinu	our God
5	אֱמוּנָתֶךָ	emunatekha	your faithfulness
6	אֱמֶת	emet	truth

Chataf kamatz ֳ · very short o as in for

1	אֳנִיָּה	oniyah	ship
2	אֳנִי	oni	fleet, shipping
3	צֳרִי	tzori	balsam
4	מָעֳדָף	mo'odaf	preferred, favorite
5	צָהֳרַיִם	tzohorayim	noon, midday, afternoon
6	לְמָחֳרָת	lemochorat	the next day

Vowel signs workbook: example words

Dagesh בּ · no sound of its own; makes b, k, p instead of v, kh, f

1	בּוֹרֵא	bore	creator
2	לַכּוֹתֶל	lakotel	to the Western Wall
3	חֶשְׁבּוֹן	cheshbon	the bill
4	אַבָּא	aba	dad
5	אַתָּה	atah	you (m.)
6	כָּתַב	katav	he wrote

Shin dot שׁ · sh as in shoe

1	שָׁנָה	shanah	year
2	חָמֵשׁ	chamesh	five (f.)
3	שֶׁבַע	sheva	seven (f.)
4	תֵּשַׁע	tesha	nine (f.)
5	גֶּשֶׁם	geshem	rain
6	שֶׁמֶשׁ	shemesh	sun

Sin dot שׂ · s as in sun

1	עֶשֶׂר	eser	ten (f.)
2	שִׂמְחָה	simchah	joy
3	וְיָשֵׂם	veyasem	and grant
4	שַׂקִּית	sakit	bag
5	נָשׂוּי	nasuy	married (m.)
6	שְׂמֹאלָה	smola	left

Shema and Priestly Blessing: expected pronunciation

Phrase	Israeli	Sephardi	Ashkenazi
שְׁמַע יִשְׂרָאֵל יְהוָה	shema yisra'el adonai	shema yisra'el adonai	shema yisro'eil adonoy
אֱלֹהֵינוּ יְהוָה אֶחָד׃	eloheinu adonai echad	eloheinu adonai echad	eloheinu adonoy echod
יְבָרֶכְךָ יְהוָה וְיִשְׁמְרֶךָ׃	yevarekhkha adonai veyishmerekha	yevarekhkha adonai veyishmerekha	yevorekhkho adonoy veyishmerekho
יָאֵר יְהוָה פָּנָיו	ya'er adonai panav	ya'er adonai panav	yo'eir adonoy ponov
אֵלֶיךָ וִיחֻנֶּךָּ׃	elekha vichuneka	elekha vichuneka	eilekho vichuneko
יִשָּׂא יְהוָה פָּנָיו אֵלֶיךָ	yisa adonai panav elekha	yisa adonai panav elekha	yiso adonoy ponov eilekho
וְיָשֵׂם לְךָ שָׁלוֹם׃	veyasem lekha shalom	veyasem lekha shalom	veyoseim lekho sholom

The divine name is read “Adonai” (Israeli, Sephardi) or “Adonoy” (Ashkenazi). The other read-aloud texts have their boxes printed on the sheets.